GreenWatt

Lead Quality Benchmark Report

HVAC

Hundreds of data points. 5 proprietary sources.
5 scoring pillars.

We Analyze Hundreds of Data Points Before a Lead Reaches You

Every lead passes through 5 independent data sources before it receives a score. No single signal determines the outcome — the system cross-references them all.

1 Phone Validation & Contact Intelligence

Phone grade, activity score, line type classification, and contact reachability analysis.

2 Property Intelligence & Financial Records

Ownership status, property type, building permits, equity position, assessed value, demographics, and 38+ property flags.

3 Identity Verification

Name matching across phone records, email accounts, and property records to verify the lead is who they claim to be.

4 Fraud Detection & Consent Verification

Bot detection, form input analysis, and account ownership verification to filter illegitimate leads.

5 Behavioral Analysis

Form fill method, lead freshness, and engagement quality indicators that reveal intent.

These data points feed into our **5-pillar scoring framework** — each lead receives a **Gold**, **Silver**, or **Bronze** grade.

Pillar 1: Contactability

Can your sales team actually reach this person?

The most qualified lead in the world is worthless if nobody picks up the phone. Contactability is the first gate every lead must pass through.

DATA POINT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	IMPACT IN HVAC
Phone Validity	Whether the phone number is real and currently active	🟢 Strong Positive — invalid = instant reject
Phone Contact Grade	Carrier-level reachability rating (A–F) based on connection history	🟢 Strong Positive — Grade A-B = high reachability
Phone Activity Score	Recent usage frequency (0–100); higher means more active	🟢 Strong Positive — Score 70+ signals active line
Line Type	Mobile, Landline, FixedVOIP, or Virtual — each carries different contact rates	🔵 Positive — Mobile/Landline preferred; FixedVOIP = caution; Virtual = Bronze cap
Grade F + Activity <40	The worst combination: unreachable number with minimal recent use	🔒 Bronze Cap — essentially a dead line
Email Validity	Whether the email address exists and can receive messages	🔵 Positive — validates secondary contact channel
Email Deliverability	Inbox placement likelihood vs. bounce or spam folder	🔵 Positive — deliverable email supports follow-up

Also analyzed: Email contact grade, email age score, free email provider detection

Indicator key: 🟢 Strong Positive 🔵 Positive ⚪ Neutral 🟡 Negative 🔴 Strong Negative ⛔ Reject 🔒 Bronze Cap

> **Contactability has a minimum 0.13 weight floor across all verticals.** Even perfect property signals can't overcome an unreachable lead.

Pillar 2: Identity Verification

Is this person who they say they are?

Cross-referencing the submitted name against independent records catches typos, shared-device submissions, and outright fabrication.

DATA POINT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	IMPACT IN HVAC
Phone Name Match	Does the submitted name match the registered owner of the phone number?	🟢 **Strong Positive** — key identity signal
Email Name Match	Does the submitted name match the name associated with the email account?	🔵 Positive — supports identity verification
Address Name Match	Does the submitted name match the resident or owner at the provided address?	🟢 **Strong Positive** — ties lead to property
Property Owner Cross-Ref	Is the lead also listed as the property owner in county records?	🟢 **Strong Positive** — owner authority helpful for HVAC work

Also analyzed: Litigator risk flag

Pillar 3: Fraud & Legal Compliance

Is this lead legitimate and safe to contact?

Fraudulent leads waste money and create legal exposure. This pillar catches bots, fabricated submissions, and compliance risks before they reach your team.

DATA POINT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	IMPACT IN HVAC
Bot Detection	Automated submission patterns — bots generate zero-value leads and inflate costs	⛔ **Instant Reject** — zero-value lead
Confirmed Account Ownership	Verified, named, or unverified — indicates how trustworthy the form submission is	🔵 Positive — verified account ownership builds trust
Form Input Method	Typed, autofilled, or pre-populated — pre-populated forms are a strong fraud signal	🔵 Positive — typing signals genuine intent; autofill = ⚪ Neutral; pre-populated = ⛔ **Reject**

Also analyzed: TCPA litigator risk

Pillar 4: Behavioral Signals

How engaged is this person — and how fresh is the lead?

Timing and engagement quality separate leads that convert from leads that go cold. Speed-to-contact is one of the strongest predictors of conversion in HVAC.

DATA POINT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	IMPACT IN HVAC
Lead Age (seconds)	Time elapsed since form submission — freshness directly correlates with contact rate	🟢 Strong Positive — under 5 minutes is ideal
Form Input Method	Typing indicates active engagement; autofill suggests convenience; pre-populated flags risk	🔵 Positive — typing signals active engagement

Lead Freshness Thresholds

FRESHNESS	SIGNAL
< 5 minutes	🟢 Ideal — highest contact and conversion rates
5 – 60 minutes	🔵 Good — still warm, act quickly
1 – 24 hours	🟡 Cooling — decreasing returns
> 24 hours	🔴 Strong Negative — significantly reduced value

Pillar 5: Property & Financial Intelligence

Does the property and financial profile match the project?

This is the most vertical-specific pillar. A signal that's strongly positive for one industry can be neutral or negative for another. Every weight is tuned to HVAC.

DATA POINT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	IMPACT IN HVAC
Owner Occupied	Does the property owner live at the address?	🟢 **Strong Positive** — owner authority for HVAC replacement
Confirmed Renter	Lead is renting, not owning — impacts project authority and financing	🔴 **Strong Negative** — renters rarely authorize HVAC replacement
Property Type: SFR	Single-family residence — the standard for most home improvement projects	🟢 **Strong Positive** — standard HVAC project
Property Type: Condo	Condominium — may have HOA restrictions on exterior modifications	🔵 Positive — condos still have individual HVAC units
Property Type: Townhouse	Townhome — shared walls, potential HOA involvement	🔵 Positive
Property Type: Multi-Family	Multi-unit property — different scope, financing, and decision-maker dynamics	🔵 Positive — multiple units, larger project
Property Type: Mobile	Mobile or manufactured home — structural limitations for many project types	⛔ **Instant Reject** — non-standard HVAC systems
Property Type: Commercial	Commercial property — different sales cycle and regulatory requirements	🔵 Positive — commercial HVAC is a significant market
Free and Clear	No mortgage — strong equity position, different financing implications	🔵 Positive — strong equity position
High Equity	Significant equity built up — access to home equity financing options	🔵 Positive — financing access
Solar Permit / Roof Permit	Active permits on file — signals recent or planned work on the property	⚪ Neutral — permits not a primary signal for HVAC
Year Built	Older homes may need more work; newer homes may have warranties still active	🔵 Positive — pre-2000 homes more likely to need HVAC replacement
Recently Sold	Recent purchase may indicate renovation intent — or recent cash outflow	⚪ Neutral
Estimated Value	Property value influences project budget capacity and financing eligibility	🔵 Positive — higher value = larger HVAC system

We Also Analyze

Each of these 38+ additional data points contributes to the property & financial score:

Tax Lien
Pre-Foreclosure
Cash Buyer
Senior Owner
Corporate Owned
Absentee Owner (In-State)
Absentee Owner (Out-of-State)
Inherited Property
Fix and Flip
Active Listing
Expired Listing
Pending Listing
On Market
For Sale By Owner
Involuntary Lien
Mailing Address Vacant
Square Footage
Lot Size
Bedrooms
Bathrooms
Stories
Construction Type
Roof Type
Roof Condition
Pool
Garage
HOA
Open Mortgage Count
Open Mortgage Balance
Estimated Equity
Loan-to-Value Ratio
Sale Propensity
Assessed Value
Tax Amount
Household Income
Net Worth
Age
Length of Residence

What Gets Blocked — And Why

Not every lead deserves your team's time. These rules fire before the scoring model runs, protecting you from the worst leads in any dataset.

⛔ Instant Rejects — Never Delivered

These leads are removed entirely. You never see them, and you never pay for them.

- **Invalid phone number** — number does not exist or cannot receive calls
- **Bot detected** — automated submission identified through behavioral analysis
- **Pre-populated form** — lead data was injected, not entered by a human
- **Household income < $25K** — below financing threshold for most projects
- **Grade F + Virtual phone combo** — unreachable number on a disposable line
- **Mobile/Manufactured property type** — non-standard HVAC systems and structural limitations

🔒 Bronze Caps — Cannot Score Above Bronze

These leads are delivered but capped. They may convert, but the data says the odds are lower.

- **Grade F + Activity < 40** — worst-case reachability; phone is essentially dormant
- **Virtual / burner phone** — NonFixedVOIP line type associated with disposable numbers

What Each Tier Looks Like in HVAC

Every scored lead lands in one of three tiers. Here's what to expect from each.

GOLD

78–100

3+ signal groups all positive. Contactable (Mobile/Landline, Grade A-B, Activity 70+), verified identity (2+ name matches), confirmed owner at SFR/Condo/Townhouse, no fraud flags. These leads are ready for your best closers.

SILVER

61–77

Solid on 2+ pillars but gaps in others. Common pattern: good phone but only 1 name match, or verified identity but FixedVOIP phone. Nothing disqualifying — worth calling, but not your top priority.

BRONZE

40–60

Notable concerns but not rejected. Low activity score, renter status, autofill-only form, or mixed property signals. These leads need nurturing, not your A-team.

Typical Tier Distribution

Based on aggregate scoring data across HVAC lead sources.

What Bad Leads Are Costing You

Without scoring, your team calls every lead equally — spending the same time and energy on bots and dead phones as they do on qualified homeowners ready to buy.

If you buy **500 HVAC leads/month** at **$100/lead**:

42% blocked (210 leads × $100)	**$21,000/mo you'd waste without scoring**
17% Bronze (85 leads)	**Your team calls these but they rarely convert**
29% Silver (145 leads)	**Solid leads worth working systematically**
12% Gold (60 leads)	**Worth prioritizing for your best closers**

$252,000

per year in wasted lead spend — eliminated with scoring

GreenWattHVAC

See These Scores on YOUR Leads

Score 10 of your HVAC leads — free.

Upload 10 leads from any source. We'll score them live across all 5 pillars. Takes 2 minutes.

Score 10 Free → greenwattconsultingresults.com/score

Rather talk to someone?
Book 15 minutes →